We want this capability for our own images.

If you think about it, this mechanism presupposes that images are hosted somewhere: somewhere that Docker knows to find them.

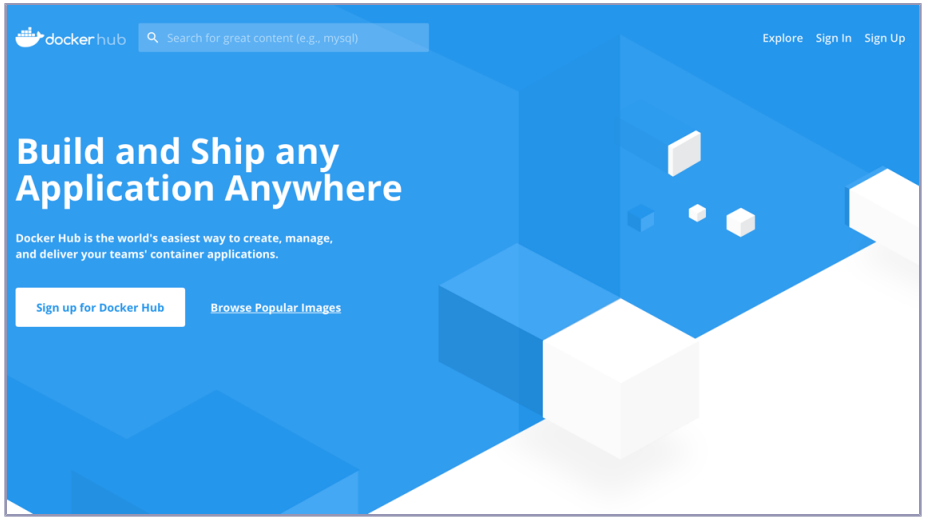
Enter Docker Registries.

Much like you'd share a Git repo by pushing it to a centralized hosting service like GitHub, we can share our Docker images by pushing them to a centralized Docker image-hosting service—or in Docker parlance, *Docker Registries*.

Docker provides its own hosted Registry called Docker Hub,[1] which with a free account, gives you unlimited public repos and one private repo. For more private repos, you can sign up for one of its paid plans.[2] However, as we'll see shortly, on page 152, there are other options, including hosting your own Docker Registry.[3]

For simplicity, we're going to use Docker Hub as our Registry throughout the rest of this book, so to follow along, you'll need a Docker Hub account. If you don't already have one, let's create it now.

Visit hub.docker.com in a browser, and sign up for an account. You'll need to choose a username—known as a *Docker ID*. I recommend using the same name as your GitHub account to keep things simple, although this is not necessary. Join me back here when you're done.



1. https://hub.docker.com
2. https://hub.docker.com/billing-plans/
3. https://docs.docker.com/registry/deploying/